

Segment 1 Rock River Rd to Parking Before Beaver Pond

Updated April 2024 [Google Map of Segment 1](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

Trail Adopter(s): None

Segment length: About 4.6 mile gravel road walk, east to west 365 ft of ascent, 99 ft of descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) : Use Maps # 49 & 50 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact the Trail Crew Leader (Brad Slagle 906 236-2776) with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: trail descriptions will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound)

This segment is a relatively easy road walk that partially skirts around the Rock River Canyon Wilderness. If continuing on to Segment 2, be sure to look at that segment guide before continuing for guidance on how to travel through the tricky beaver pond area.

From your vehicle at (46.392142,-86.915399), head west on [*Cole Creek Rd/CR 437 /USFS 2276/Johnson Lake Tower Rd*] for approximately 3.5 miles. Turn left on to [*Falls Rd/CR 408/USFS 2293*] for approximately 1 mile to the second parking area. (46.424791,-86.977818)

As you pass the Rock River Falls Spur in the Rock River Wilderness, you may want to take the 1.2 mile spur down to the falls. It is a very delightful waterfall in a secluded wilderness setting. No trail markings are present but the trail is well worn and easily followed.

Driving Directions:

Eastern Trailhead

From M-28 west of Au Train, head south on [*Rock River Rd/H01*] approximately 5 miles to the trailhead at the intersection of Rock River Rd and [*Sandstrom Rd/CR 437 /USFS 2276/Johnson Lake Tower Rd*] just before you cross the Rock River. For those who prefer to follow a Google Map, here is the ([Driving Map M28/US 41 in Harvey to Rock River Rd parking](#)). Parking for this trailhead is at the P icon. **Park at the parking along Rock River Rd, do not turn left and continue to the beaver pond parking.**

Alternately, from M-94 on the south, you can drive north approximately 3.3 miles from Chatham on [*Rock River Rd/H01*]. Once you cross the Rock River, the trailhead at [*Sandstrom Rd/CR 437 /USFS 2276/Johnson Lake Tower Rd*] will be on your left. For those who prefer to follow a Google Map, here is the [Driving Map from Chatham to Rock River Rd parking](#). Parking for this trailhead is at the P icon. **Park at the parking along Rock River Rd, do not turn left and continue to the beaver pond parking.**

Western Trailhead

Follow the driving directions to the Eastern Trailhead, and then the trail description above to drive to the Western Trailhead. If you prefer to follow a Google Map, here is the [Driving Map from M28/US41 in Harvey to parking before beaver pond](#) and here is the [Driving Map from Chatham to parking before beaver pond](#). Do not park at the P icon, but continue to the end of the track.

Camping:

The Rock River Canyon Wilderness is south of Cole Creek Rd. so dispersed camping is available. There are private landowners on the north of Cole Creek Rd., so please do not camp on their property. Once on Falls Rd, the Wilderness is on both sides so dispersed camping is available.

Water Access:

Water is available at the Rock River near the eastern trailhead.

Seasonal Access Information:

The eastern trailhead should be reachable year-round, although an AWD vehicle may be preferable.

From late spring through early winter a higher clearance vehicle is necessary to reach the western trailhead.

The western trailhead is not reachable via vehicle in the wintertime.